

INDIAN ECONOMY

LEVEL
II



LECTURES

AN OVERVIEW ABOUT RICE AND
WHEAT CROPS - Part II

MODULE - 62



FINE CEREALS

PADDY – PROMINENT PRODUCING STATES



AVG. PRODUCTIVITY – KG/HA

India – 2,659
World – 4,679

WHEAT – PROMINENT PRODUCING STATES



AVG. PRODUCTIVITY – KG/HA

India – 3,507
World – 3,425

WHAT IS THE MEANING OF 'PARBOIL'?

- The dictionary meaning is 'partly cooked by boiling'.
- Thus, the parboiled rice refers to rice that has been partially boiled at the paddy stage, before milling.
- Parboiling of rice is not a new practice and has been followed in India since ancient times.



There is no specific definition of parboiled rice in India.

WHAT IS THE NORMAL PROCESS OF PARBOILING?

- The paddy is soaked for 8 hours.
- The water is then drained, and it is steamed for 20 minutes.
- Also, the paddy is dried in the shade in the method used by the CFTRI, Mysuru, but drying under the Sun is the common method.

There are several differences in the processes across the country. For example, Paddy Processing Research Centre (PPRC), Thanjavur follows a method known as the chromate soaking process. It uses chromate, a family of salts in which the anion contains both chromium and oxygen, which removes the odour from the wet rice.



Parboiled rice



White rice



MORE CLARITY ABOUT PARBOILING

- To put it straight, it involves 3 stages—soaking, steaming and drying.
- After passing through these stages, the paddy goes for milling.
- All varieties can be processed into parboiled rice, but it is ideal to use long slender varieties to prevent breakage during milling.
- However, aromatic varieties should not be parboiled because the process can make it lose its aroma.

WHAT ARE THE ADVANTAGES?

- Parboiling makes rice tougher. Hence, it reduces the chances of the rice kernel breaking during milling.
- Parboiling also increases the nutrient value of the rice.
- Parboiled rice has a higher resistance to insects and fungi.



WHAT ARE THE DISADVANTAGES?

- The rice becomes darker and may smell unpleasant due to prolonged soaking.
- Moreover, setting up a parboiling rice milling unit requires a higher investment than a raw rice milling unit.



WHY DID TELANGANA WANT PARBOILING?

During the Rabi season, the breakage of rice will be high. Hence, Telangana wants parboiling to reduce the breakage of rice.



WHY IS THE FCI NOT IN FAVOUR OF PROCURING PARBOILED RICE FROM TELANGANA?

- The demand for parboiled rice has come down in recent years. At present, the parboiled rice demand is just around 20 Lakh tonnes per annum for distribution under the National Food Security Act, 2013.
- In the last few years, production in the parboiled rice-consuming states, such as Jharkhand, Kerala and Tamil Nadu has increased, resulting in less movement to the deficit States.
- The FCI also says that the stock of parboiled rice in 2022 is sufficient to meet the demand for the next 2 years.

WHEAT PRODUCTION ESTIMATES WERE LOWERED BY THE GOVERNMENT IN 2021-22 RABI SEASON

- The Government lowered its wheat production estimates by 5.7% to 105 Million Tonnes (MT) from the projected 111.32 MT for the crop year ending June, 2022.
- The fall is on account of unusually warm weather conditions that persisted during March to April, 2022 in most parts of the key grain-producing States of Punjab, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh as well as Uttar Pradesh.

WHEAT PROCUREMENT WAS ALSO HIT BADLY!

- Wheat procurement in the ongoing Rabi marketing season had seen a major drop.
- Centre procured just around 20 MT of wheat. In the last marketing year, the Government had purchased 43.3 MT of wheat from farmers, and in 2022, it had set a target of 44.4 MT and it could achieve the procurement of only 20 MT.



HEATWAVES HIT THE WHEAT PRODUCTION SIGNIFICANTLY!

- Unprecedented heatwaves across the north, west and central parts of the country during March/April 2022 have caused substantial loss to the yield at about 6%. Unofficial estimates say that the drop is much higher.
- March and April in 2022 are the hottest in over 100 years in several regions of the country.



WHY WAS THE PROCUREMENT HIT BADLY ?

- In many States, farmers were selling wheat to traders/ exporters at prices Rs. 21 to 24 per kg, which was better than the MSP rate of Rs. 20.15 per kg.
- Farmers were also holding on to some quantity of wheat, expecting higher prices for their produce in the near future.



Anticipation of further price rise, market price already higher than MSP and lower production - are the prominent reasons for the massive fall in the wheat procurement in 2022.

THERE IS A LURKING DANGER IN WHEAT DUE TO CLIMATE CHANGE!



Political will is necessary to bring progressive changes in fine cereals cultivation to ensure reduction in financial and environmental costs from a long-term perspective.

- Indian wheat is at the limit of heat tolerance.
- Any unusual rise in day temperatures during growing season can hurt wheat yields. Hence, over-dependence on the north-western region for wheat procurement may not be advisable.
- Procurement should gradually shift to other states by building robust procurement infrastructure.

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